

May 26, 2026 12:29 PM GMT

Chemicals | North America

Chinese Urea Export Window Opens

Market sources report that China has opened its urea export window. At this point, first round volume has not been confirmed, but trade sources suggest ~1.9mT, including ~400kT of government to government sales. Prices floors have reportedly been set at \$660/t FOB for prilled urea, \$670/t FOB for granular urea, and \$680/t FOB for prills being sent to India. The reported floor prices sit above most current major benchmark levels.

Current benchmark prices include: (i) Brazil, at a range of \$600–640/t CFR; (ii) US NOLA, at a range of \$545–575/st FOB; (iii) Southeast Asia, at a range of \$675–685/t CFR; (iv) the Baltic Sea, at a range of \$590–620/t FOB; and (v) the most recent Indian tender, which had lowest offers at \$935/t CFR, although letters of intent were issued on April 23 when global prices were higher than they are today.

Please see [Exhibit 1](#) and [Exhibit 2](#) within this note for historical Chinese urea export data.

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CHEMICALS	
North America	
Industry View	In-Line

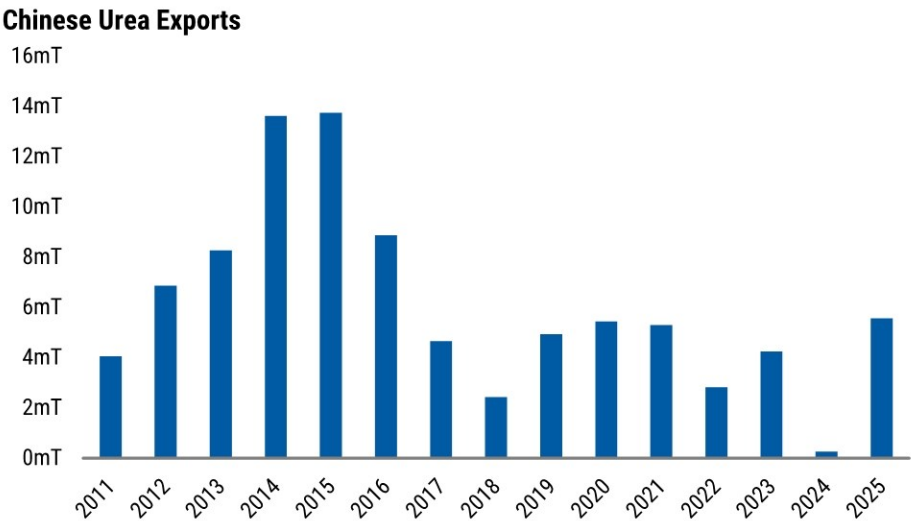
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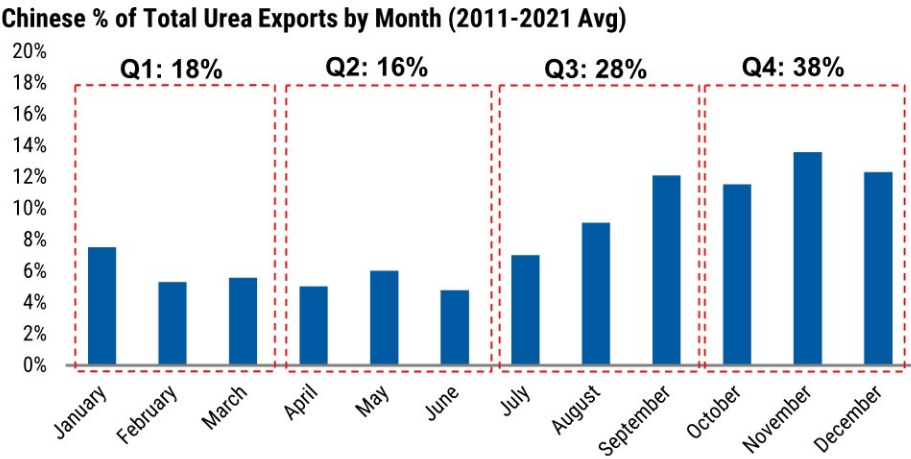
Historical Exports

Exhibit 1: Historical Chinese Urea Exports



Source: CRU & Morgan Stanley Research

Exhibit 2: Chinese Urea Export Seasonality



Source: CRU & Morgan Stanley Research

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(as of April 30, 2026)

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Stock Rating Category	Coverage Universe		Investment Banking Clients (IBC)			Other Material Investment Services Clients (MISC)	
	Count	% of Total	Count	% of Total IBC	% of Rating Category	Count	% of Total Other MISC
Overweight/Buy	1546	42%	467	51%	30%	709	44%
Equal-weight/Hold	1568	43%	358	39%	23%	715	44%
Not-Rated/Hold	4	0%	0	0%	0%	1	0%
Underweight/Sell	555	15%	84	9%	15%	202	12%
Total	3,673		909			1627	

Data include common stock and ADRs currently assigned ratings. Investment Banking Clients are companies from whom Morgan Stanley received investment banking compensation in the last 12 months. Due to rounding off of decimals, the percentages provided in the "% of total" column may not add up to exactly 100 percent.

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COMPANY (TICKER)	RATING (AS OF)	PRICE* (05/22/2026)
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ICL Group Ltd (ICL.N)	E (01/05/2024)	\$6.46
International Flavors & Fragrances (IFF.N)	O (11/11/2024)	\$75.28
Steven K Haynes, CFA		
Ashland Inc. (ASH.N)	E (09/08/2025)	\$57.21
Vincent Andrews		
Air Products and Chemicals Inc. (APD.N)	E (05/29/2025)	\$289.47
Albemarle Corporation (ALB.N)	E (12/15/2025)	\$171.58
Avient Corporation (AVNT.N)	E (12/14/2020)	\$34.31
Axalta Coating Systems Ltd (AXTA.N)	++	\$29.22
Celanese Corp. (CE.N)	E (01/20/2026)	\$52.39
CF Industries (CF.N)	E (05/25/2016)	\$121.70
Chemours Co (CC.N)	E (01/30/2018)	\$21.37
Corteva Inc. (CTVA.N)	O (12/14/2020)	\$79.56
Dow Inc. (DOW.N)	E (12/01/2019)	\$36.01
DuPont De Nemours Inc. (DD.N)	E (05/26/2021)	\$48.12
Eastman Chemical Co (EMN.N)	O (01/17/2019)	\$74.12
Ecolab Inc. (ECL.N)	O (01/28/2025)	\$253.32
FMC Corporation (FMC.N)	E (10/24/2023)	\$13.11
Huntsman Corp (HUN.N)	E (12/11/2023)	\$14.51
Intrepid Potash (IPI.N)	U (10/03/2013)	\$39.51
Linde PLC (LIN.O)	O (02/09/2020)	\$517.58
LyondellBasell Industries N.V. (LYB.N)	O (12/01/2019)	\$69.72

Mosaic Company (MOS.N)	E (03/16/2016)	\$22.51
Nutrien Ltd (NTR.N)	O (01/14/2026)	\$70.13
Olin Corp. (OLN.N)	U (01/10/2023)	\$26.03
PPG Industries Inc. (PPG.N)	E (11/01/2019)	\$107.78
RPM International Inc. (RPM.N)	E (12/14/2020)	\$100.90
Sherwin-Williams Co. (SHW.N)	O (03/19/2014)	\$309.08
Tronox Holdings Plc-Class A (TROX.N)	E (01/30/2018)	\$7.55
Westlake Corp (WLK.N)	E (01/09/2018)	\$88.60

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